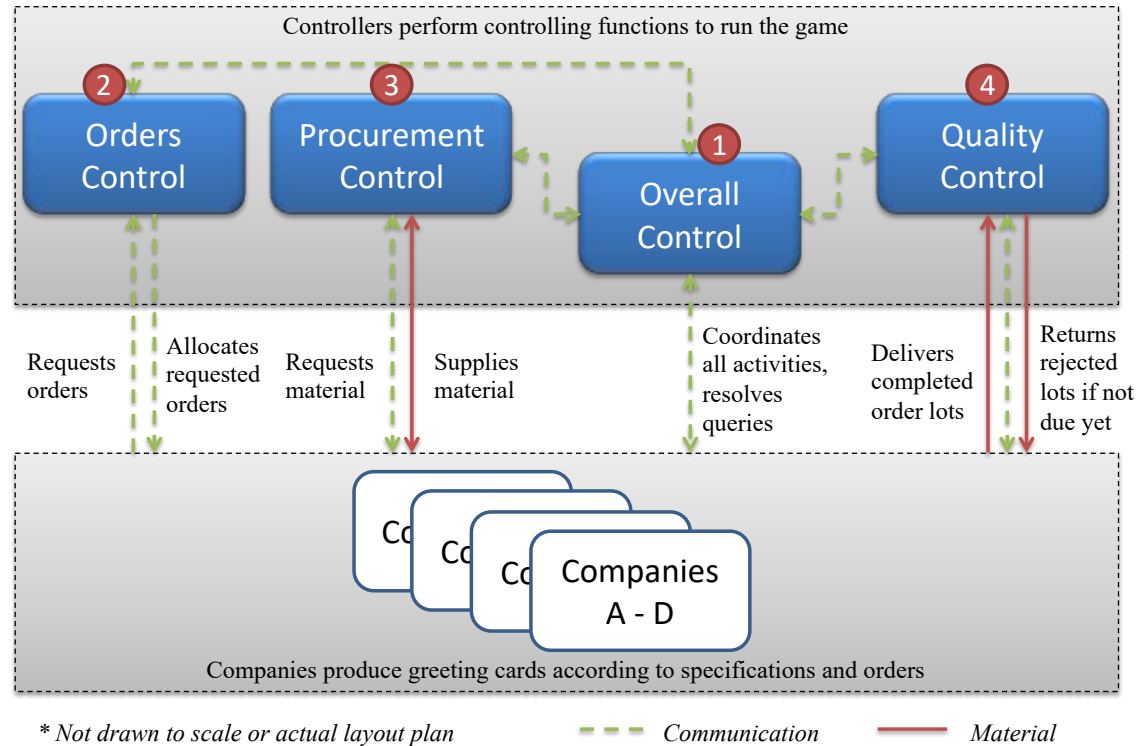




3P4 Operations Management

Production Game Briefing

Tariq Masood (tm487@cantab.ac.uk)

Lent 2026 / 4th March

Playing the Production Game

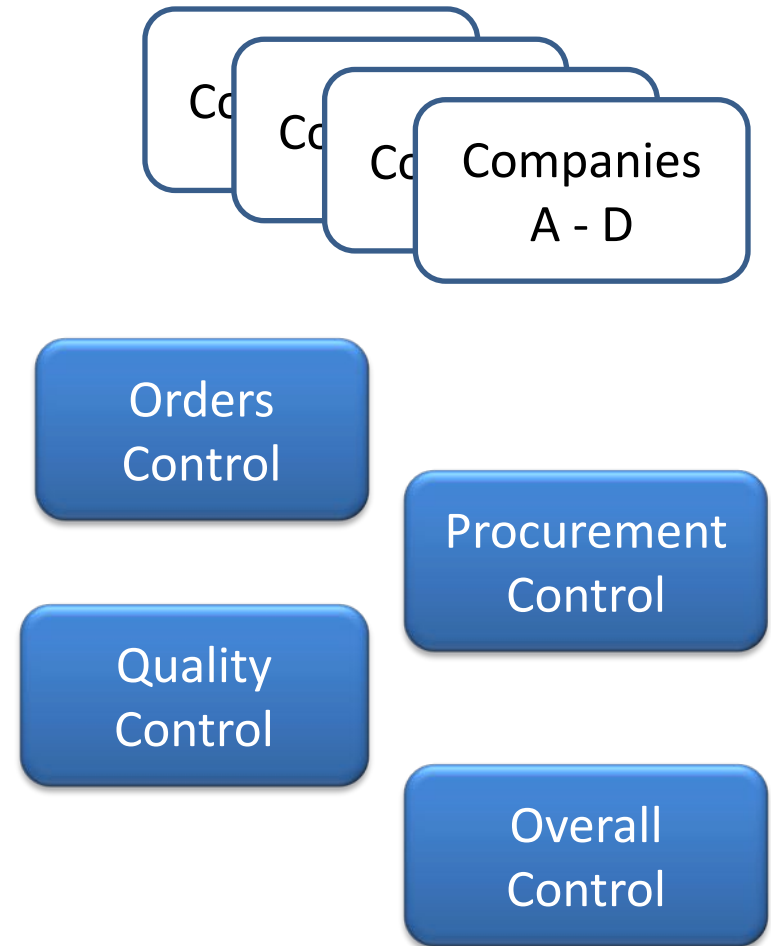
- Production Game will be held on **13th March 2026**
- You are divided into **FOUR** teams (aka companies)
- Purpose is to demonstrate the principles in designing and operating a simple manufacturing system to produce greetings cards



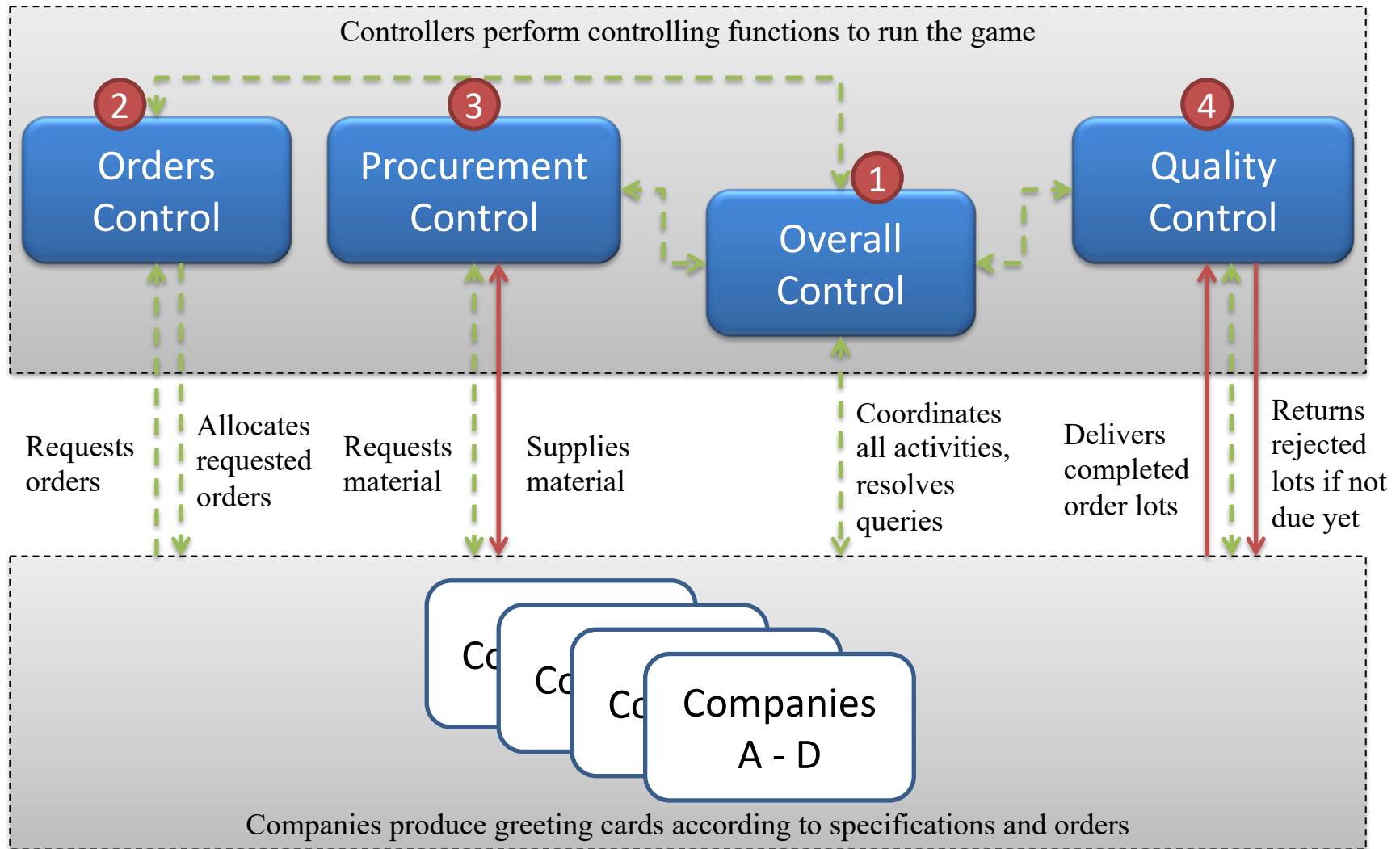
MET Production Game

Key elements

- The manufacturing system
- Selection of orders (from the market) - orders control
- Purchase of materials – procurement control
- Delivery to customers – quality control
- Overall planning, control, strategy, improvement, accounting



Key processes



* Not drawn to scale or actual layout plan

--- Communication

— Material

Orders

- Price of an order depends on aspects like occasion, lead time, quantity, colour, size and verse.
- What will be your orders management strategy?



Occasion	Quantity	Colour	Size	Verse	Leadtime	Price
Christmas	4	White	A5	6	15	£ 106.00
Christmas + New Year	8	Salmon	A6	4	20	£ 440.00
New Year	12	Green	A6	4	25	£ 504.00
Birthday	4	Yellow	A7	2	30	£ 144.00
Wife's Birthday	8	Pink	A5	6	Open	£ 232.00
Husband's Birthday	12	Blue	A6	4	15	£ 1,032.00
Father's Birthday	4	White	A6	4	25	£ 84.00
Mother's Birthday	8	White	A7	2	15	£ 280.00

Procurement

What will be your team's procurement strategy?

Starting inventory (£3100)



Forms are
free



Specifications

Procurement Form

Inter-company
Transactions Form

Final Accounts Form

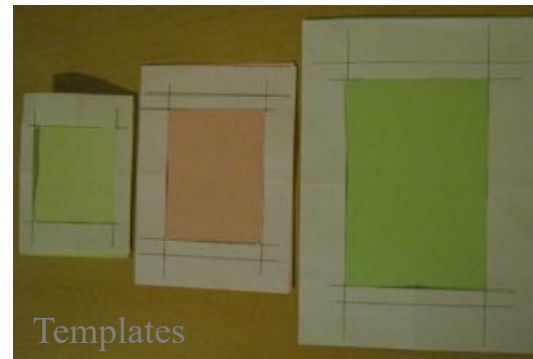


Quality

- How will you minimise rejections?
- You may bring pre-prepared quality control templates.



Specifications



Templates



2018



Production



MET Production Games



Disruption

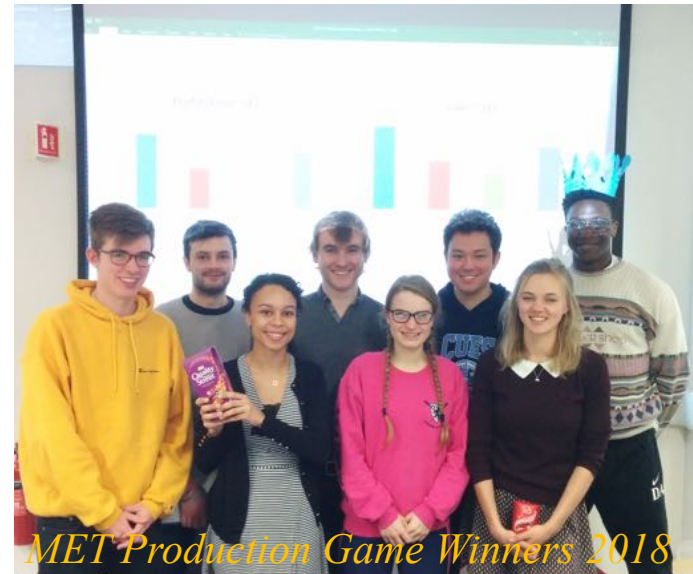
Plan for production capacity disruptions!
e.g., instances where some % or all of
production capacity is lost.



MET Production Games - Production under Disruption

Overall Control

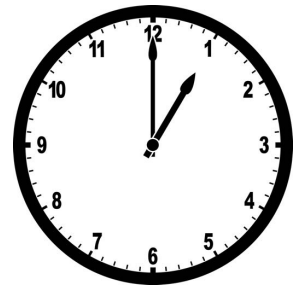
Focus on maximising profit!



Deliverables and evaluation

- Two deliverables
 - Pre-game (team) report on strategy and planning (due before the game starts, i.e., 1300hrs on 13th March)
 - Post-game (individual) coursework (due before 1200hrs on 20th March)
- Evaluation
 - Pre-game report (50%)
 - Individual coursework (50%)

Schedule for 13th March



12:00 Design studio closed for game set up

13:00 Design studio opens

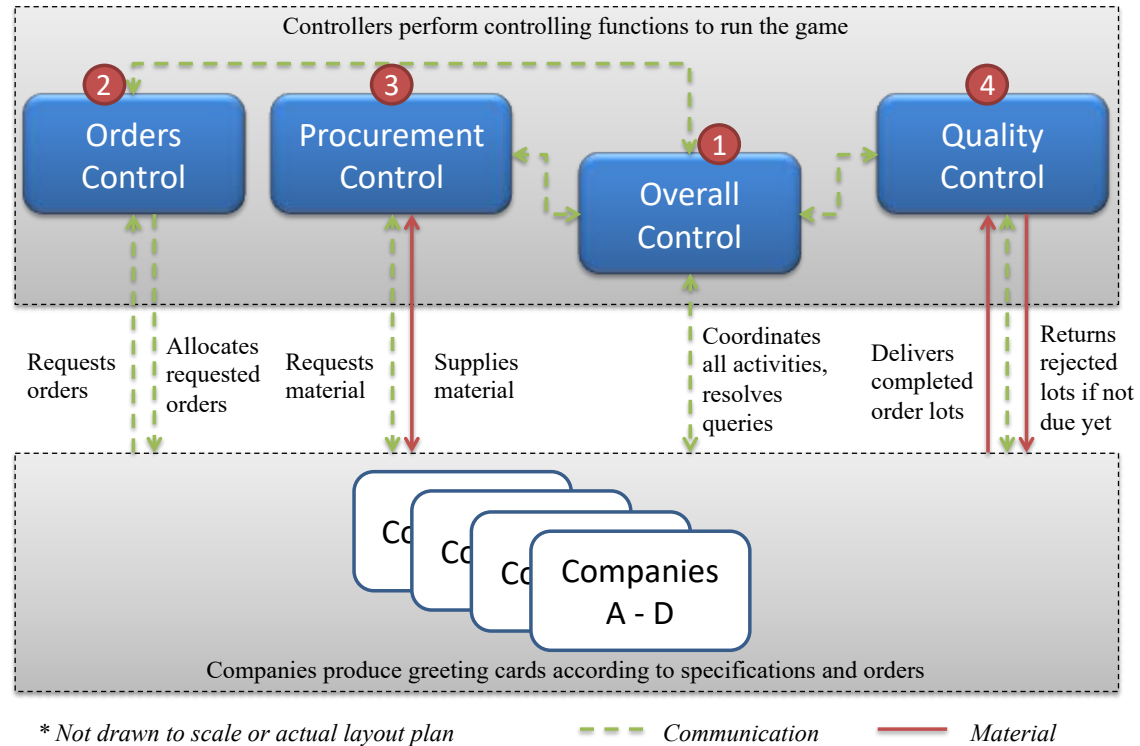
13:05 Briefing starts

13:30 Trading commences

15:30 Trading ceases. All materials to controllers.
Companies reflect on the game and prepare
short report-backs. Controllers calculate
performance

16:30 (approx.) Discussion. Each company presents on
its strategy and performance (10 mins each)

17:15 (approx.) Close



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